PP-L-800E
September 9, 1986
SUPERSEDING
PP-L-800D
MAY 20, 1975

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

LUNCHEON MEAT, CANNED (READY TO EAT)

This specification is approved by the U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA) for use by all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification is for the procurement of canned luncheon meat which shall be vacuumized and heat processed for long shelf life and packaged 30 ounces (850 g) or 6 pounds (2.72 kg) net weight per can as specified by the purchaser.

1.2 Classification. The product shall be one of the following types as specified by the purchaser:

Type I - Beef and pork (not less than 30 percent beef or 30 percent pork).
Type II - All beef.
Type III - All pork.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government publications. The issues of the following documents, in effect on date of invitation for bids or solicitation for offers, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications

TT-C-495	- Coatings, Exterior, for Tinned Food Cans
PPP-B-636	- Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

FSC 8905

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U.S. Department of Agriculture

Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers
Visual Aids for Inspection of Rigid and Semirigid Containers

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Director, Market Research and Development Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

Military Specifications

MIL-L-1497	- Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items
MIL-L-35078	- Loads, Unit: Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items; Clothing, Personal Equipment and Equipage; General Specification for

Military Standard

MIL-STD-129	- Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Copies of Military specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 **Other publications.** The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bid or solicitation for offers shall apply.

Association of Official Analytical Chemists (AOAC)

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 1111 North 19th Street, Suite 210, Arlington, VA 22209.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 2200 Mill Road, Alexandria, VA 22314.)

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Uniform Classification Committee, Agent

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Suite 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 **Source of commodity.** The meat shall be from animals slaughtered in, and the finished product shall be prepared and handled in, an establishment regularly operated under the Meat and Poultry Inspection (MPI) Regulations of the USDA except that packed, boneless meat which has been initially accepted for use in the product may be frozen and stored in commercial cold storage warehouses.

3.2 **Material.**

3.2.1 **Meat.** Pork and/or beef shall be the only meat ingredients used. Hearts, tongues, and other items which are normally separated from the carcass during dressing are not allowed. All meat shall be in excellent condition; i.e., exposed lean and fat surfaces shall be of a color and bloom typical of meat which has been properly stored and handled. Cut surfaces and naturally exposed lean surfaces shall show no more than slight darkening or discoloration due to dehydration, aging, or microbial activity. The fat shall show no more than very slight discoloration due to oxidation or microbial activity. No odors foreign to fresh meat shall be present. Changes in color and odors characteristically associated with vacuum-packaged meat in excellent condition shall be acceptable. The meat shall show no evidence of freezing, defrosting, or mishandling. In addition, oily, or coarse-textured dark pork is not acceptable.

Except for hot-processed meat (meat derived from animals slaughtered on same calendar day as canning), all meat shall be initially certified for condition as specified in section 4.3 (**Examination for excellent condition**). Following condition certification, any portion of the meat may be excluded in any combination at the contractor's option. All meat shall be made boneless and may be frozen and stockpiled for later use. Hot-processed meat may be derived from any portion of the carcass and shall be processed on the day of slaughter.

3.2.2 **Other ingredients.** Other ingredients (salt, curing ingredients, sweetening agents, spices, flavorings, etc.) shall be as allowed under MPI Regulations to meet the end item requirements.

3.3 **Processing.**

3.3.1 **Handling and storage.** Handling and storage of boneless meat prior to processing into the finished product shall be in accordance with one or any combination of the following methods as declared to the AMS agent by the contractor:

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a. **Same day processing.** Fresh-chilled meat canned on the same calendar day of initial certification shall not exceed 50°F (10.0°C) at any time up to heat processing.

b. **Fresh-chilled storage.** Fresh-chilled meat not canned on the same calendar day of initial certification can be held up to 96 hours from the time the container holding the boneless meat is sealed by the AMS agent, provided the meat does not exceed 40°F (4.4°C) at the time of further processing. However, if the temperature of the meat at the time offered for further processing exceeds 40°F (4.4°C) but is less than 50°F (10°C), that meat may be processed on the same calendar day provided it is reexamined for condition in accordance with the stationary lot reexamination criteria in TABLE I of section 4.3.2. If the temperature of the meat exceeds 50°F (10°C) at any time prior to the beginning of heat processing, it shall be rejected.

Dry ice or liquid nitrogen may be used to maintain these temperatures. Product failing these temperature requirements will be rejected. Fresh-chilled boneless meat destined for use in the finished product, but held for more than 96 hours from the time the container holding the boneless meat is sealed by the AMS agent, shall be reexamined for condition in accordance with the stationary lot reexamination criteria in TABLE I of section 4.3.2, provided the temperature of the meat does not exceed 40°F (4.4°C) at the time offered for further processing.

c. **Frozen storage.** Fresh-chilled meat not canned on the same calendar day of initial certification may be frozen and stockpiled for later use provided it is processed not more than 60 days from the initial certification date. The boneless beef and pork shall be packaged separately, placed in the freezer within 4 hours following the time the container holding the boneless meat is sealed by an AMS agent and frozen to an internal temperature of 0°F (-17.8°C) or lower within 72 hours after it is placed in the freezer. Boneless meat assigned to freezing shall be packaged and packed in commercial containers that are adequate to maintain product excellence during freezer storage. Containers shall be labeled as "Boneless Pork for PP-L-800E September 1986" or "Boneless Beef for PP-L-800E September 1986". Examination for frozen temperature requirements shall be as specified in section 4.4 (**Examination for temperature of frozen meat**).

The meat shall be maintained frozen at 0°F (-17.8°C) or lower during storage, and the internal temperature shall not exceed 40°F (4.4°C) when further processing is resumed.

d. **Hot-processed meat.** Meat canned on the same calendar day of slaughter shall be processed in a continuous operation.

3.3.2 **Formulation.** When Type I is specified, meat shall consist of both beef and pork in the following combination: not less than 30 percent beef or 30 per-

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cent pork. When Type II is specified, beef shall be the only meat ingredient, and when Type III is specified, pork shall be the only meat ingredient.

Product from opened cans used for the finished product examination may be "reworked" into nonprocessed product of the same type provided: (1) it complies with MPI Regulations; (2) not more than 2 percent of such product is incorporated into a batch of nonprocessed product; (3) the product is derived only from lots that have been accepted after the finished product examination; and (4) the reworked product is added to nonprocessed product within 48 hours of heat processing.

Curing ingredients shall be added to the meat components at any time prior to or during the grinding or chopping process. The product shall be heat processed within 48 hours after curing ingredients are added.

3.3.3 **Preparation of meat prior to canning.** Unless otherwise specified, boneless meat shall be ground and/or chopped as necessary to meet the end item texture requirements specified in Table III of section 4.5.2.

Optionally, the purchaser may specify that the meat shall be prepared by grinding as follows: Meats which are prepared by grinding shall be thoroughly blended and ground twice. The final grind for beef shall be through a plate having holes 1/8 inch (3.2 mm) in diameter, and for pork, the final grind shall be through a plate having holes 3/16 inch (4.8 mm) in diameter. The initial and final grinding process shall be a continuous operation. Under this option, defect 202 in TABLE III shall not be scored.

3.3.4 **Mixing, can filling, vacuumizing and thermal processing.** The product shall be mechanically mixed and packed into clean cans. The filled cans shall be vacuumized, sealed, and thermally processed for long term nonrefrigerated storage.

NOTE: If, at any time after initial certification, the AMS agent observes meat which is in less than excellent condition or not in compliance with other specification requirements, the agent shall reject the involved lot.

3.4 **End item requirements.**

3.4.1 **Fat and salt content.** The fat and salt content shall be determined in an AMS laboratory in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists.

Unless otherwise specified, the fat content analysis of the sample shall not exceed 25.00 percent. Product exceeding 25.00 percent fat shall be rejected.

NOTE: The purchaser may specify discount ranges (see 6.1c.) for fat content analyses in the 22.01 to 25.00 percentage range.

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Unless otherwise specified, the salt content analysis of the sample shall be not less than 1.50 percent nor more than 3.00 percent. Product not meeting this requirement shall be rejected.

3.4.2 **Physical Characteristics.** Product shall comply with the physical characteristics specified in TABLE III of section 4.5.2 (Physical characteristics examination).

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 **Contractor's responsibility.** Examination and certification by AMS shall not relieve the contractors of their obligation to deliver a product complying with all the requirements of this specification. The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting it to AMS for any examination.

4.2 **Examination and supervision.** Product acceptability shall be determined by an AMS agent. In accordance with Meat Grading and Certification Branch Instruction MGCB 918-2, G-16, and other MGCB instructions and notices, the local meat grading supervisor will determine the degree of supervision necessary to assure specification compliance. The cost of all grading and certification services performed by the AMS agent involving examinations, supervision, official documentation, related services (including samples for fat and salt content analyses and charges for such analyses), and travel and mileage charges when applicable, shall be borne by the contractor.

4.3 **Examination for excellent condition.** Fresh-chilled bone-in or boneless meat shall be examined for condition (as described in section 3.2.1) using either the 100-percent or stationary lot (TABLE I) examination procedure. Determination of wholesomeness and acceptability of meat with respect to the presence of foreign material (e.g., glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, or metal) shall be made by a Meat and Poultry Inspection Operations (MPIO) employee.

The procedure used shall be specified by the contractor and agreed to by the AMS agent. Lot sizes shall be as defined for each procedure. However, the AMS agent reserves the right to declare as a lot a portion of a declared lot if, in the agent's opinion, that portion may indicate gross noncompliance with any of the specification requirements or if production is seriously interrupted.

4.3.1 **100-percent.** This procedure may be used to examine fresh-chilled bone-in or boneless meat for condition requirements (as described in section 3.2.1) provided the meat is in portions of at least 3 pounds (1.4 kg). Boneless meat in portions less than 3 pounds (1.4 kg) shall be examined by the stationary lot method (section 4.3.2).

4.3.2 **Stationary lot.** This procedure may be used to examine fresh-chilled bone-in or boneless meat of any portion size (cuts and/or trimmings) for condition requirements. The lot size, expressed in terms of pounds (kg), shall be as declared to the AMS agent by the contractor. The sampling plans for meat are listed in TABLE I. The randomly selected sample units shall be a minimum of

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12.0 pounds (5.4 kg) of adjacent meat and shall be evaluated for compliance with the excellent condition criteria (as described in section 3.2.1). Lots containing product in less than excellent condition shall be rejected and cannot be reworked and reoffered.

TABLE I. STATIONARY LOT SAMPLING PLAN

Lot Size (pounds (kg))	Initial Examination Sample Size (number of sample units)	Defects Ac	Re	Reexamination 1/ Sample Size (number of sample units)	Defects Ac	Re
15,000 or less (6803.9 kg or less)	20	0	1	32	0	1
15,001 or more (6804.0 kg or more)	32	0	1	50	0	1

1/ Applicable to fresh-chilled meat held for more than 96 hours (see 3.3.1b.).

4.4 **Examination for temperature of frozen meat.** At 72 hours after placement of meat for later processing into the freezer, the AMS agent will take one temperature reading from product in each of three boxes randomly selected from the lot. Any individual reading above 0°F (-17.8°C) shall cause rejection of the lot.

4.5 **Examination of finished product.**

4.5.1 **Lot.** Except as otherwise specified, examinations performed for specification compliance shall be done on a production lot basis by the AMS agent.

For the purpose of this specification, a production lot is: (1) the quantity (number of cans) of finished product designated by the contractor as the unit for determining compliance with specification requirements; or (2) that portion of a contractor's designated production lot which the AMS agent designates as a unit for determining compliance if, in the agent's opinion, that portion is or may be out of compliance with one or more specification requirements. Unless otherwise specified, the lot size shall not exceed an offer unit or the amount of product produced in a single workshift.

4.5.2 **Physical characteristics examination.** The sampling plan used shall be that set forth in TABLE II. Product having an internal temperature of 50°F to 80°F (10°C to 26.7°C) shall be randomly selected for this examination. Classification of defects shall be in accordance with TABLE III. For examination, each core shall be divided into four approximately equal pieces by three

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straight cuts perpendicular to the cutting table surface and at an approximate right angle to the core length. The right hand surfaces shall be evaluated by the AMS agent. Failure of the sample to comply with the acceptance criteria shall cause rejection of the lot. Product used for physical characteristics examinations shall remain the property of the contractor.

All cans of product within each lot shall bear identical markings to make them distinguishable from cans of product in other lots. Except when it is necessary to use a portion of a lot to complete a delivery unit, each lot shall be shipped as an intact unit. Individual lots shall not be split among more than three delivery units.

TABLE II. SAMPLING PLAN FOR FINISHED PRODUCT CHARACTERISTICS

Lot Size (cans)		Sample Size (cans)	Defect Categories			
			MAJOR		TOTAL	
30 ounce (850 g) cans	6 pound (2.72 kg) cans		Ac	Re	Ac	Re
10,000 or less	3200 or less	13	1	2	3	4
10,001 or more	3201 or more	20	2	3	5	6

TABLE III. FINISHED PRODUCT PHYSICAL CHARACTERISTICS DEFECT CLASSIFICATION

Defect Categories		
Major	Minor	Defects 1/ 2/ 3/
101		Product does not remain intact when removed from the can.
102		Product does not have a uniform reddish-brown color. (Slight variation between internal and external surfaces is permitted.)
103		Presence of bone 0.3 inch (7.6mm) or more in any dimension.
104		Presence of cartilage, ligaments, or tendons 0.5 inch or more in any dimension.
	201	Product is not uniform in texture.

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TABLE III. FINISHED PRODUCT PHYSICAL CHARACTERISTICS DEFECT CLASSIFICATION (CON'T)

Defect Categories		
Major	**Minor**	**Defects 1/ 2/ 3/**
	202	Product is not moderately fine to slightly coarse in texture. 4/
	203	Product does not yield an intact 0.2 inch (5.1 mm) thick slice and/or has broken edges (crumbling). 5/ 6/
	204	Presence of more than 2 pockets of fat, gelatin, and/or air on any individual surface greater than 0.3 inch (7.6 mm) in the longest dimension.
	205	Presence of fat covering more than 10 percent of the outer core surface.

1/ Determination of wholesomeness and acceptability of product with respect to the presence of foreign material (e.g., glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, or metal) shall be made by an MPIO employee.

2/ The presence of bone shall be reported to the MPIO employee.

3/ Presence of product evidencing a foreign odor or flavor (e.g., burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, or stale) shall cause rejection of the lot.

4/ Not scored if grinding is specified in section 3.3.3.

5/ To be scored only once per sample unit.

6/ Slice shall be made not less than 1 inch (2.5 cm) from either end.

4.5.4 **Withdrawal of samples for fat and salt content analyses.** After completion of the can filling operation for each lot, eight cans of product shall be randomly selected for analysis. The product from the eight cans shall be formed into a composite sample by thorough mixing, after which the cans shall be refilled. Three cans of the composite sample shall be randomly selected by the AMS agent, and the contents of these cans shall be prepared by reducing the consistency of the composite sample to a thoroughly blended mixture. After the composite sample is prepared, the meat must be repacked and the cans sealed. All sample cans shall be marked to identify them with the applicable lot and to distinguish them from cans of that lot or cans or samples from any other lot.

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After thermal processing, these three cans shall be distributed as follows:

1 - One shall be submitted to the laboratory.

2 - One shall be submitted to the contractor.

3 - One shall be retained by the AMS agent as a reserve sample to be used if the original is lost or if requested by AMS or the contractor.

However, analysis of the reserve sample at the request of the contractor shall not be permitted unless the original analysis indicated that the involved production lot will be discounted or rejected because of noncompliance with the fat or salt content requirements. When the reserve sample is analyzed, the results of such analysis shall be considered final. Cans of composite sample mixture, in excess of the three selected above, may be thermal processed and included in the production lot. Unused reserve samples shall be submitted to the contractor.

4.5.5 **Drained weight examination.** Examination for drained weight shall be performed on all units examined under TABLE II. Surface fat and dripping moisture shall be removed from cores used in this examination. Also, meat adhering to the can shall be excluded. Meat cores shall be weighed in the aggregate, and the total weight (in ounces) shall be divided by the number of sample units to determine the average drained weight.

If: (1) only the first sample (13 or 20 cans as designated by the sampling plan) was needed to accept a lot for finished product characteristics, and (2) the average drained weight is less than 27 ounces for 30-ounce cans, or less than 5 pounds, 8 ounces for 6-pound cans, then a second sample of the same number of cans may be added (at the contractor's request) to the original sample. The average drained weight of the **total** number of cans sampled will determine the final drained weight. Lots with average drained weight which is less than 26 ounces for 30-ounce cans or less than 5 pounds, 4 ounces for 6-pound cans, shall be rejected.

NOTE: The purchaser may specify discount ranges within the acceptable limits.

4.6 **Examination for condition of shipping containers and cans.** Examination for determining compliance shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers. The examination shall be performed on the delivery unit not more than three working days prior to loading. The applicable AMS Visual Aids for Inspection of Containers shall be used by the AMS agent as references when determining the severity of container defects.

4.7 **Examination at time of shipment.** At time of shipment, if the product appears to be out of compliance with any of the specification requirements, it may be reexamined at the discretion of the AMS agent.

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NOTE: The remaining section 4 requirements are for the Department of Defense procurements when specified by the contracting officer.

4.8 **Can vacuum examination.** Cans shall be tested for satisfactory vacuum by holding cans which are free of visible defects or damage for at least 24 hours at 70°F to 80°F and testing immediately on removal from the testing temperature as follows: Lay a straight edge from bead to bead along the center of one side of the can, other than the side seam side, and observe the profile directly under the straight edge. The distance from the straight edge to the can side shall be greater at the middle of the can than it is near the beads (end seam). The sampling plan used shall be that set forth in TABLE II.

4.9 **Can condition examination.** Examination of filled and sealed cans shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers except that inspection for labeling shall be in accordance with MIL-L-1497.

4.10 **Shipping container examination.** Shipping containers shall be examined for defects in assembly, closure, and reinforcement (when applicable) in accordance with PPP-B-636.

In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows:

Major: National stock number, item description, contract number or date of pack markings missing, incorrect or illegible. Reinforced with other than nonmetallic strapping or tape. Dimensions of pads not as specified.

Minor: Other required markings missing, incorrect, or illegible. Interior packing with fiberboard liner or pads not as specified. Arrangement or number of cans not as specified.

Level C containers shall be examined only for the marking, number of can defects specified above, and closure method specified.

4.11 **Unit load inspection.** Inspection of unit loads shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging, packing, and marking requirements.

5.1.1 **Cans.** Cans shall be commercially acceptable, open-top style, coated with enamel (or other suitable material) inside and outside, and hermetically sealed. The following can sizes are acceptable:

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30 ounce (850 g) net weight

Size	Shape
401 X 411	Cylindrical
404 X 404	Cylindrical

6-pound (2.72 kg) net weight

Size	Shape
400 X 400 X 1106 to 1110	Rectangular
402 X 314 X 1200	Rectangular
402 X 310 X 1204 to 1210	Rectangular

If specified by the purchaser, the cans shall be lined with parchment paper or plastic material to separate the product from the sides of the can. If not specified by the purchaser, the contractor may elect to use such liners in or to meet other specification requirements.

5.1.2 Packing.

a. Unless otherwise specified, products shall be packed as follows:

Twenty-four 30 ounce (850 g) cans of product shall be packed snugly on end in two layers, four lengthwise, and three crosswise.

Six 6-pound (2.72 kg) cans of product shall be snugly packed on end in one layer, three lengthwise, and two crosswise.

b. Product shall be packed into new corrugated fiberboard (Type CF) or solid fiberboard (Type SF) regular slotted containers (RSC). These containers shall be class domestic with a minimum bursting strength of 275 psi. The AMS agent shall use the boxmaker's certificate label to determine minimum bursting strength. Containers shall be packed to full capacity without slack filling or overfilling.

c. Fiberboard containers shall be securely closed using one, or a combination, of the following methods:

- Strapping - Two lengthwise straps shall be applied over the outer flaps, and two girthwise straps shall be placed to divide the box into units of approximately equal length. When this method is used, initial closure shall be in accordance with the gluing or stapling method.

- Gluing - A sufficient amount of glue or hot-melt adhesive shall be applied to prevent lifting of edges and corners of the outer flaps.

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- Stapling - Staples shall be of sufficient number and distributed to securely close and prevent lifting of edges and corners of the outer flaps. The gluing, taping, or strapping method shall be used for the final closure.

- Taping - Commercially acceptable tape, 2.0 inches (5.1 cm) wide, shall be centered over the seam(s) formed by closure of the outer flaps. The tape shall extend onto the end panels to securely close and prevent lifting of edges and corners of the outer flaps.

NOTE: The AMS agent maintains the right to verify, using appropriate test procedures, that packaging and packing materials comply with these requirements.

5.1.3 **Markings.** Can and shipping container markings shall be as prescribed in applicable contract or solicitation document.

NOTE: The remaining section 5 requirements are for the Department of Defense procurements when specified by the contracting officer.

5.2 **Packaging.** Packaging shall be Level A or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 **Level A.** A net weight of 6 pounds of product shall be packaged into one of the following can sizes: 400 by 400 by 1106 to 1110, 402 by 310 by 1204 to 1210, or 402 by 314 by 1200. The cans shall be hermetically sealed, key-opening style, rectangular, metal cans with soldered or welded side seams. The key shall be securely attached to the bottom of the can by welding or soldering using a noncorrosive flux. The can shall be made throughout from not less than 0.25 pound per base box electrolytic tinplate. The can shall be coated overall on the outside with a coating conforming to Type I or II, or when specified (see 6.1) Type III of TT-C-495. Each can shall be lined with a commercial vegetable parchment paper which separates the product from the sides of the can. Cans shall be closed under sufficient vacuum to pass the examination specified in 4.8.

5.2.2 **Level C.** The product shall be packaged as specified in 5.2.1, except that cans with or without commercial exterior coating will be acceptable. Alternatively, the product shall be packaged in accordance with 5.2.1, except that cans may be made from 0.20 pound per base box electrolytic tinplate instead of 0.25 pound tinplate, provided the can is coated with a commercial exterior coating.

5.3 **Packing.** Packing shall be Level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.3.1 **Level A packing.** Six 6-pound cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.2.1, shall be packed on end, three in length and two in width in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in acordance with Style RSC-L, Grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be separated from each other by full height partitions made from Grade W5c Fiberboard. In addition, each box shall be provided with top and bottom pads made from Grade W5c fiberboard. Each

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shipping container shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.1). Strapping of unit loads shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for Type II, Class F loads.

5.3.2 **Level B packing.** Six 6-pound cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.2.1, shall be packed on end, three in length and two in width, in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with Style RSC-L, Grade V3c, V3s, or V4s of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be separated from each other by full height partitions made from Grade W5c fiberboard. In addition, each box shall be provided with top and bottom pads made from Grade W5c fiberboard. Each shipping container shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.3.3 **Level C packing.** Six 6-pound cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.2.2, shall be packed in a shipping container complying with the Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification.

5.4 **Unit loading.** When specified (see 6.1), the product, packed as specified in 5.3.2 and 5.3.3, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified. When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping.

5.5 **Labeling and marking.**

5.5.1 **Cans.** Cans shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497.

5.5.2 **Shipping containers.** Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.5.3 **Unit loads.** Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078.

6. NOTES

Any procurement activity outside the Federal government may utilize this specification or any modification thereof. USDA certification may also be specified by these activities, but modification of the document will not be allowed without appropriate approval from the Market Research and Development Division located at:

U.S. Department of Agriculture
Agricultural Marketing Service
Market Research and Development Division
14th and Independence Avenue, SW
Washington, DC 20250

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6.1 **Procurement data.** The procuring agency shall specify in the contract or solicitation document the following, as applicable:

a. Product type (Type I, Type II, or Type III).

b. Drained weight (if other than specified herein) and discount range, if any.

c. Fat content (if other than specified herein) and discount range, if any.

d. Can size.

e. Packaging and packing requirements (if other than specified herein).

f. Shipping container markings.

g. Offer unit size.

h. Preparation of meat prior to canning (if other than specified herein).

i. Use of parchment paper or plastic can liners (if desired).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Military Coordinating Activity

Army - GL

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review Activities

Army - MD, TS
Navy - MS, MC
DP - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - FDA, NIH
USDA - MRD
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

USDA - LS

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